

Eggless Low-Carb Bhapa-Doi Style Cheesecake (Arrowroot Version)

A creamy, lightly sweet Bengali-inspired Bhapa Doi cheesecake made eggless and lower carb using Greek yogurt, paneer, and monkfruit sweetener. This dessert can be steamed for a traditional silky Bhapa Doi texture or baked for a firmer cheesecake-style finish.

Ingredients

- 1 cup full-fat Greek yogurt (thick)
- 150–200 g paneer, blended smooth
- 1/2 cup monkfruit-erythritol sweetener
- 1.5 tsp arrowroot flour
- 1/4 cup fresh cream (optional but recommended)
- 1/4 tsp cardamom powder
- Few saffron strands (optional)
- Pinch of salt
- 1 tsp lemon juice (optional for tang)

Steamed Version — Traditional Bhapa Doi Texture

- Blend paneer until completely smooth.
- Add Greek yogurt, sweetener, arrowroot, cream, cardamom, saffron, salt, and lemon juice.
- Mix gently until smooth and creamy.
- Pour into greased ramekins or heatproof container.
- Cover tightly with foil.
- Steam on low heat for 20–25 minutes.
- Edges should be set while center remains slightly jiggly.
- Cool completely and refrigerate 6–8 hours before serving.

Baked Version — Cheesecake Texture

- Preheat oven to 300°F / 150°C.
- Pour batter into lined 6–7 inch pan.
- Place pan inside a water bath.

- Bake 30–35 minutes until mostly set.
- Cool inside oven with door slightly open.
- Refrigerate overnight before slicing.

Important Tips & Tweaks

- Use thick strained Greek yogurt for best texture.
- Blend paneer thoroughly to avoid graininess.
- Do not over-steam or over-bake or texture may become rubbery.
- Water bath helps prevent cracks in baked version.
- Arrowroot gives a softer Bhapa Doi-like texture than cornstarch.
- Allow full chilling time for proper setting.
- For richer texture, increase cream slightly.
- For firmer slices, increase arrowroot to 2 tsp.

Interesting Variations

- Rose Cardamom Version: add rose water and pistachios.
- Mango Bhapa Doi Cheesecake: swirl in sugar-free mango puree.
- Coffee Cheesecake Version: add espresso powder.
- Chocolate Version: add cocoa powder and dark chocolate.
- Masala Chai Version: infuse cream with chai spices.
- Pistachio Saffron Version: add pistachio paste and extra saffron.
- Coconut Version: replace some cream with thick coconut cream.
- Baked Crust Version: use almond flour butter crust.

Serving Suggestions

- Serve chilled.
- Top with chopped pistachios or almonds.
- Drizzle with saffron milk reduction.
- Serve with berries for contrast.
- Can be portioned into ramekins for elegant presentation.

Approximate Nutrition (Per Serving)

- Calories: ~140–180
- Protein: ~8–10g
- Net Carbs: ~3–4g
- Fat: ~10–13g

Storage

- Store refrigerated up to 4–5 days.
- Texture improves after overnight chilling.
- Can be frozen though texture may soften slightly after thawing.